Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Butcher and meat-counter professional with nine years of experience in butchery and meat-counter service, including carcass breakdown, boning, trimming and portioning in the butcher role since 2019. Experienced in beef, pork and lamb preparation, fresh sausage making, FIFO stock rotation, and HACCP-related temperature and hygiene checks. Known for practical product knowledge and helpful advice on cuts and cooking times.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb *2019–present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the service counter.
- Prepare approximately 40 kg of fresh sausage per week in the busy season, including čevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the čevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback; the čevapi won second place at the 2023 Zagreb County craft meat fair.
- Rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, placing older products at the front.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve approximately 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts, quantities and cooking times.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting orders, including weddings and family events; completed the largest order of 4 lambs and 2 pigs for a 180-guest wedding in 2024.
- Conducted a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs in 2024, recording temperature and weight loss; dry-aged rib is now available by pre-order at the shop.
- Trained 2 apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb *2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Wrote a closing and cleaning checklist for the slicer, mincer, counter and floor drain following a market hygiene inspection remark.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) *Food Trades School Zagreb | 2015*
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024
Preparing for the Master Butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb) · Boning, trimming and portioning · Fresh sausage making · FIFO stock rotation · HACCP-related temperature and hygiene checks · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Customer service and advice on cuts and cooking · Fresh-meat packaging by paper wrapping · Cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good) · German (basic)